

Saving for a home

What was once a fairly standard milestone in adult life for many has become a huge, sometimes seemingly unachievable, goal as property prices have rocketed over the last couple of decades. Depending on where you live, the amount that you need to save for a house deposit, and the amount you need to earn to meet banks' mortgage affordability criteria, is really daunting. I've spoken to many fellow millennials who have said that their saving motivation has been all but extinguished by the intimidating target of the tens of thousands of pounds required for a down-payment, so they choose to divert their funds towards more immediate and enjoyable ventures.

And yet housing security is one of the 'safety' needs in Maslow's hierarchy. For all of us, having a roof over our heads and a fixed address is absolutely paramount not only to our wellbeing but to our ability to function in society. A home to call your own, whether you rent or have a mortgage, is a very basic human need, and yet housing security for private tenants in the UK is sketchy at best. Writing for the *Guardian* about 'the looming mental health crisis for Generation Rent',² Rhiannon Lucy Cosslett outlined the many ways in which insecure housing can affect our mental wellbeing, from frequent moves to having to relocate and leave support networks behind. 'A lack of housing affordability isn't just a question of cash,' she writes, 'It has the potential to affect our sense of stability, our wellbeing and mental health, and our family planning. A home is so much more than a roof over your head.'